



SECOND TRIMESTER CHANGES

Welcome to the Second Trimester

The second trimester is often called the most comfortable phase of pregnancy. Nausea typically decreases, energy often returns, and the baby bump becomes more visible.

Body Changes During the Second Trimester

- The uterus expands noticeably above the pubic bone.
- Weight gain becomes more apparent (typically 1 pound per week).
- Skin changes may include a dark line (linea nigra) on the abdomen.
- Braxton Hicks contractions (mild, practice contractions) may begin.
- Round ligament pain may cause brief, sharp pain as ligaments stretch.
- Back pain and pelvic pressure increase as the baby grows.
- Nasal congestion and nosebleeds may occur due to increased blood flow.
- Leg cramps, especially at night, are common.

Fetal Development Highlights

- By week 16, the baby can make facial expressions.
- By week 20, fetal movements (quickening) may be felt for the first time.
- By week 24, the baby's lungs begin developing surfactant for breathing.
- The anatomy scan ultrasound is typically performed around weeks 18–20.

Warning Signs

- Unusual or heavy vaginal bleeding
- Severe abdominal pain
- Signs of preterm labor before week 37
- Decreased fetal movement after week 24

Key Takeaway

The second trimester brings exciting milestones including feeling the baby move. Continued prenatal care is essential for monitoring both parent and baby health.

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

Educational content informed by American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists. (2021). Your pregnancy and childbirth: Month to month (6th ed.). Mayo Clinic. (2023). Fetal development: The second trimester. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. (2022). Prenatal care.